



New wave for old tech

From pagers to fax machines, there are some "obsolete" technologies that are still being used. <https://digit.in/apr20-37>



Smart insoles

Google and Adidas have teamed up to launch a smart insole for soccer shoes that tracks how good you are. <https://digit.in/apr20-38>

Poco X2

Near perfect experience ruined by pesky ads

We still don't know where the Poco F2 is, but we do have a certain Poco X2 to talk about.

That's the new smartphone that the now-independent brand launched recently. Here's our in-depth review.

Design and display

With the Poco X2, you get a unique design that uses Gorilla Glass 5 on both sides along with nicely curved edges and a rather big body. The display, on the other hand, is also quite unique. The Poco X2 features an 6.67-inch IPS LCD display with a 120Hz refresh rate. As for panel brightness, we measured 576 lux under direct sunlight, while indoors the brightness went down to 6 lux.

Camera

The Poco X2 packs a 64MP camera in the quad camera stack. It uses a new Sony IMX686 sensor. There's another 8MP ultrawide lens and two 2MP lenses for macro photos and depth sensing respectively. On the front, there are two punch-hole cameras including a 20MP selfie shooter and an accompanying 2MP depth sensor.

The 64MP sensor performs 4-in-1 pixel binning. AI scene recognition enhances the contrast and saturation. So, in some cases nice and crisp with lots of details, but sometimes, everything looks far too over processed. The dedicated night mode is pretty good. A big downside is you can only capture stationary objects using the night mode. Also, only the primary and the telephoto camera support nightmode. The images have accurate colours, and little noise. The dynamic range is not so good and you will have dark areas with no details.

The 2MP macro lens performs the poorest among the four lenses. While the images look sharp, they hardly carry any detail. It's also only good for using



Price
₹15,999



BUILD AND DESIGN.....76
FEATURES.....78
PERFORMANCE.....76
VALUE.....77

when there's enough light. The aperture is just too small to use in low-light.

Performance

Powering the phone is the Qualcomm Snapdragon 730G, a gaming-centric 7-series SoC that's been paired with up to 8GB RAM

and 256GB UFS 2.1 storage. Interestingly, only the CPU benchmarks were allowed to run while GPU testing apps like 3DMark and GFXBench were locked down. With the limited number of benchmarks apps that were unlocked, it looks like the Poco X2 offers the best CPU performance in this segment, but only by a small margin. Then again, the company decided to lock down the GPU benchmarks which doesn't instill much confidence in the device.

We played a host of games including the popular ones like PUBG Mobile as well as some games which Poco claimed will support the high-refresh rate. PUBG Mobile failed to hit peak frame rates of even 60fps. PUBG Mobile went up to 30 FPS. None of the games we

played managed to go beyond 60 FPS, thereby rendering the 120Hz refresh rate display pointless in gaming. Still, the phone doesn't heat up a lot even after prolonged gaming sessions.

Poco UI raises a red flag for us, since it will bombard your notifications with ads that are outright obscene. There are a bunch of bloatware apps which send push notifications despite not being logged in to any account once again adding to an already long list of apps pushing ads in the UI. Leaving that aside, the Poco UI is minimal, fast and supports the 120Hz refresh rate display.

The Poco X2 rocks a 4500mAh battery. In our video loop test, the Poco X2 lasted a good 14 hours 21 minutes while 15 minutes of COD: Mobile and 30 minutes of Netflix drained the battery by 4 percent and 5 percent respectively. The Poco X2 also comes with a 27W charger out of the box.

Bottomline

The Poco X2 feels more like a knee-jerk reaction to the competition rather than a product conceived through a thought-out product plan. The 120Hz refresh rate display is something really good to see in this segment, but as of now, there's not much you can do with it. Having said that, the Snapdragon 730G at a price of ₹15,999 is pretty amazing. The performance chops it brings can be harnessed to support just about any game or app. The camera setup needs more polish which we hope gets improved with updates, but it's really the software and the menace of unsolicited notifications that mars the experience, to the extent that it becomes hard to recommend this phone to our readers. The Poco X2 ticks all the boxes in the spec-sheet, but ultimately fails to deliver a hassle-free experience.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.67 inch Full HD+ LCD, 120Hz | PROCESSOR: Qualcomm Snapdragon 730G | GPU: Adreno 618 | RAM: 6GB | INTERNAL STORAGE: 64GB (Expandable up to 512GB) | REAR CAMERAS: 64MP + 8MP (ultrawide) + 2MP (macro) + 2MP (depth) | FRONT CAMERAS: 20MP + 2MP Dual Front Camera | BATTERY: 4500 mAh Lithium-ion Polymer, Fast Charging 27W | OS: Android 10.0, MIUI 11 | FINGERPRINT SENSOR: Side-mounted

CONTACT

Poco India | PHONE: 1800-572-7626 | EMAIL: service.in@poco.net | WEBSITE: <https://www.poco.in/in/>